# UNIT-3

## Topic-4-

## PROXEMICS

UNIT-3

# PROXEMICS- proximity

- Proxemics  is the study of  physical space in interpersonal relations.
- Space is related to behavioral norms.
- The way people use space tells you a lot about them.
- In a professional setting , space is used to signal power and status.
- Eg: the head of a company has a larger office than more junior employees and you as a speaker , will have an open space before you when addressing an audience.
- You should use the psychological power of this space to your advantage.
- Your gesture should be in accordance with the space available.
- You can learn a great deal about how to use space to great advantage by observing dynamic , influential speakers.





## Examples of Proxemics

- Separate and spacious cabin is given to the employee working at a higher post.
- Use of space also reflects the power and authority such as a house in an elite, posh area.

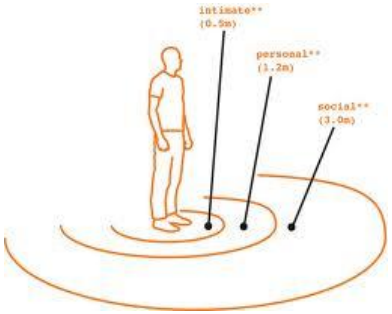
## Cultural Variations

- Proxemics also has cultural variations:
- A Latin American or a French is likely to stand closer to another person when conversing .
- Americans, addressed from a closer distance , may feel offended or become aggressive.
- Americans, unlike many other nationals avoid close contact with one another in public places.

# DISTINCT ZONES OF PROXEMICS

Edward T Hall in his book ‘ The Hidden Dimensions’ has divided space into four distinct zones:

- Intimate :(starts with personal touch to 18 inches)
- Personal : ( 18 inches to 4 feet)
- Social : (4 feet to 12 feet)
- Public : (12 feet to 30 feet and till the range of eyesight and hearing)



# Intimate Zone

- This zone starts with personal touch and extends just to 18 inches(one and a half feet)
- Members of family , lovers , spouses , relatives and parents
- The best relationship describes is mother- child relationship
- No words are spoken  if at  all spoken then just the whispering sounds
- Other individuals come closer for a very brief period , only in some special  circumstances – when they want to congratulate you , sympathize  with you , or console you
- A handshake , a pat on the back , or a hug all come into this zone.

## Personal Zone

- This zone stretches from 18 inches (one and a half feet) to 4 feet
- Your close friends , colleagues , peers etc.
- Normal talking takes place
- This zone is personal , it is quite a relaxed and casual place
- It allows spontaneous and unprogrammed communication
- Sitting or standing so close brings you closer to the listener
- Gives the impression of friendliness or warmth

# Social Zone

- Social events take place in the radius of 4 feet to 12feet
- Relationships are more official
- You tend to become more formal
- People are more cautious in their movements



- You should be smart enough to conduct with less emotion and more planning
- Number of people decide sitting – sitting or sitting – standing position
- Through experience  you decide which position to take
- If less people, you can maintain eye contact , you can take sitting position
- If authoritative and audience is large, you can take sitting standing position

## Public Zone

- This zone starts from 12 feet and may extend to 30 feet or to the range of eyesight and hearing
- Events taking place in this zone are formal.
- Audience  is an  impartial observer.
- The degree of detachment is very high.
- Audience is free to do what ever it feels like.
- Speaker has to raise his voice to communicate or use a microphone.
- Distance is maintained for security reason.
- Eg. Public figures like- PM

# QUESTIONS?

- **Q1**.Explain the distinct zones mentioned by Edward T.Hall.
- Q2. write a short note on Proxemics.
- Q3. Write a short note on Paralinguistics.
- Q4.Briefly mention the characteristics nuances of voice.